Pride Girlfriend

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/19027711.

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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the other princesses are there too, plus Bow and Sea Hawk, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, no powers, Catra is a useless lesbian, Everyone Is Gay, and they're all going to pride, I don't know anything about pride, But I Wanted To Write Fluff, because Catradora deserves fluff, One Shot, okay now it turned into a, Two Shot

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by Crackedblackice

Summary

"What the fu…" She wanted to yell at the person that was turning her around again, but the words were stuck in her throat as she looked into the face of a beautiful blonde girl. The stranger was a few inches taller than Catra and she had really blue eyes. Her shirt showed a unicorn with rainbow wings on it, that looked like it was drawn by a child, and said "PRIDE! And Apples." The girl had rainbow flags on her cheeks and a bright grin on her face.

"Hey, I noticed you earlier and you seemed kinda lonely and uncomfortable. And since nobody should be alone at Pride, you could be my Pride-Girlfriend, what do you say? I'm Adora by the way." The stranger – Adora – said all these words so fast that Catra couldn't quite keep up. Okay, maybe the fact that Catra was too gay to function played a role in it as well. And Adora's hand on her arm didn't exactly help either.
The blonde was grinning at her, patiently waiting for an answer.

"Yes."

OR Catra doesn't want to go to Pride but does so anyway and gets a girlfriend

Notes

Hey guys!
Here is just a short and fluffy Pride one shot for you!
I've never been to Pride but I wanted to write this little piece anyway cause it was fun.
Enjoy!

Chapter 1

Catra shoved her hands into the pockets of her leather jacket and looked to the ground as she pushed through the crowd. Today was the big Pride Parade in Bright Moon (or Pride Moon, as some idiots liked to call it) and there were thousands of people with rainbow flags, colorful outfits and way too loud music on the streets.

Catra didn't exactly know, why she was even there to be honest. She successfully avoided Pride for years now, although she was out since forever. Yes, she was gay. But she was also an introvert with a badass reputation to uphold. And she hated overly happy imbeciles, who chanted dumb slogans the whole day. But Catra was also very curious after only watching Pride from afar and secretly she wished, she could be more open and… well, proud about her own sexuality. After years of hearing shit about it from her foster parents she couldn't quite shake the impression, that she shouldn't shout out her sexual orientation. All the more reason to actually do just that. So, she naturally was very conflicted about the whole Pride thing.

But today she had just put on her biker boots, her favorite leather jacket over her flannel and had exited her apartment without much thinking. She kind of regretted it now. There were so many people and loud noises and she didn't know anyone. Catra knew that her friends Scorpia and Entrapta had to be there somewhere but calling them just wasn't an option. Scorpia had begged her to come along since freshman year at Bright Moon University and she would have a field day, if Catra would actually show up. Catra would never hear the end of it and her image would be shattered forever. So, no "Super Pal Trio" meeting (Scorpia also won't be allowed to name anything for the next few years). Catra should just go home, this was a dumb idea anyway. As she turned around to do just that, someone grabbed her wrist.

"What the fu…" She wanted to yell at the person that was turning her around again, but the words were stuck in her throat as she

looked into the face of a beautiful blonde girl. The stranger was a few inches taller than Catra and she had really blue eyes. Her shirt showed a unicorn with rainbow wings on it, that looked like it was drawn by a child, and said "PRIDE! And Apples." The girl had rainbow flags on her cheeks and a bright grin on her face.

"Hey, I noticed you earlier and you seemed kinda lonely and uncomfortable. And since nobody should be alone at Pride, you could be my Pride-Girlfriend, what do you say? I'm Adora by the way." The stranger – Adora – said all these words so fast that Catra couldn't quite keep up. Okay, maybe the fact that Catra was too gay to function played a role in it as well. And Adora's hand on her arm didn't exactly help either.

The blonde was grinning at her, patiently waiting for an answer.

"Yes."

Wait! What? Catra had tried to find a reason – any reason really – to say no, walk away and never think about this day until she died. She hadn't found one but was going to say no anyway. Obviously, her mouth hadn't got the message. This was stupid. As she was trying to comprehend what exactly just happened, her "Pride-Girlfriend" (*is that a real thing??*) rambled something about her friends standing in front of the big stage. Suddenly Adora stopped talking and looked at Catra like she had just asked a question.

Shit.

"What?" Catra asked dumbly and internally slapped herself because she apparently couldn't form more than one word in the presence of a pretty girl.

Adora just laughed and repeated "What's your name? I should know such things, now that we are a temporary couple, don't you think?"

"Oh. Yeah. Catra. I mean, my name's Catra." Not her best introduction but at least a whole sentence.

"Nice to meet you, Catra." Adora smiled so brightly at her that she had to look away for a second. Then she felt herself being dragged through the crowd.

"You're gonna love my friends! They're all super cool and nice!"

I bet.

Adora's friends were… she couldn't even find the words to describe them. And she thought her own friends were crazy. As Adora pulled her up to a group of five people – all dressed as one color of a rainbow – she regretted the decision to leave the house today more and more.

"Hey, Adora! Who is your new friend?" shouted a hyperactive boy in an orange crop top.

"Hey, guys! This is Catra, she is going to be my Pride-Girlfriend for the day!" Adora grinned.

"What the hell is a Pride-Girlfr…" A girl with sparkly pink hair and clothes tried to ask but was silenced by the elbow of crop top guy.

"Nice to meet you, Catra! I'm Bow." Crop top smiled and waved at Catra.

"Nice to meet you too… I guess." She suppressed the urge to awkwardly wave back. This was all too weird for her. Next in line of introduction was a girl in green with flowers in her hair – Perfuma – and then a girl in blue with matching hair – Mermista – with her boyfriend in yellow (who had a mustache, an honest to god mustache) who called himself Sea Hawk. The sparkly girl was Glimmer, she learned. *What a dumb name, even for someone who has a friend named Sea Hawk…*

They were all loud and happy and way too… extra for Catra's liking, she thought as she observed them. But they were one

thing too that Catra envied: proud. They didn't care what others thought of them and their silly behavior because they had each other. Their friendship and loyalty were so evident, that even she could see it. Suddenly she felt a little guilty for going alone to Pride and not telling Scorpia and Entrapta.

Her thoughts were interrupted by a shit ton of questions from Adora's friends about herself, how she liked Pride, if she wanted to have rainbow color on her cheeks too…

"I'm an introvert and not that confident about the whole Pride thing. Aaand apparently, I have no filter whatsoever." Catra blurted out. *What is wrong with me??*

"You say that, like it's a bad thing." Adora smiled warmly at her and squeezed her hand. *When did she grab my hand?* "But seriously, if it's too much or you're feeling uncomfortable, just say something and we'll get you out of here in no time."

Catra stared at Adora for a few moments. She didn't know that these were the words she needed to hear but apparently Adora knew. Catra smiled back gratefully, squeezed Adora's hand as well and actually felt a little calmer. Maybe this was not such a bad idea at all.

"OH MY GOD, KITTY!! What are YOU doing here??" An all too familiar voice shouted as a giant woman in red broke through the crowd, followed by a girl with purple pig tails.

Oh no.

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

Happy belated Trans Visibility Day! And Happy Pride Month!
You guys asked and I deliver, so here is the second chapter of my little fic.
Thank you for all the kudos, comments and bookmarks. I've been blown away by your kind reactions!
And special shout-out to Alice! Without her I wouldn't have posted this and none of you would read it now.
So, without further ado... enjoy Chapter 2!

"Kitty?" Sparkles asked amused while Scorpia scooped Catra up into a giant bear hug.

"Scorpia!" Catra hissed. "Personal. Space. Remember?"

"Oh right, sorry!" Scorpia let go of her and Catra brushed some imaginary wrinkles out of her clothes to hide her embarrassment.

"But what *are* you doing here? Not that I want to complain or anything, but you said that Pride is for idiots."

"Actually, she said – and I quote – 'This whole Pride shit is for stupid morons, who just want to feel important for a day.'"

"Thank you for this correction, Entrapta. It helped a lot." Catra ran her hand over her face. *Can this get any worse?*

"No problem! I have a recording of this too, if you want to…" Entrapta already searched one of her thousand pockets for her recorder.

"No, thank you!" Catra almost shrieked.

"Entrapta! You're finally here!" Bow exclaimed as he caught sight of the newcomers.

“Wait, you two know each other?”

“Yeah, we go to the same engineering class.” He explained.

“Yes, indeed! Last week’s assignments were really interesting, don’t you think?” And with that Entrapta and Bow got into an intense conversation about some robotics bullshit and forgot about the rest of them.

“So…” Adora stepped in. “Stupid morons, huh?”

For a moment, Catra hadn’t been aware of the beautiful girl right next to her. But now the whole situation came crushing back to her. Catra turned bright red and started to panic. How could she fix *this?* She must’ve had come across like a total asshole. She quickly tried to think of a good excuse for her dumb previous self. That’s when she noticed the mischievous grin on Adora’s face and the twinkle in her eyes. She was just messing with her.

“Yeah, well…” Catra shrugged. “I guess, I just didn’t know better.” *Good save. Now say something smooth.* “Luckily you showed me how wrong I was. You’re certainly not a stupid moron, that’s for sure. But you’re definitely *something*.” She said with a suggestive hint in her voice.

Adora looked as surprised of her sudden boldness as Catra felt. For the first time since she met the pretty blonde, she had actually said what she'd wanted to say. And judging by the look on Adora’s face it had worked.

Before Adora could reply though, their moment was interrupted by the loud voice of Scorpia. Again.

“Hi, I’m Scorpia! Catra’s roommate! How do you two know each other?” She asked with her typical excitement.

“Oh, I just saw her in the crowd and thought ‘Wow, what an amazing woman. And it looks like she’s alone, maybe I get lucky and she wants to spend some time with me.’ So, I went over and asked her to be my Pride-Girlfriend and she said yes.” Adora

smiled at Catra like this was the best thing that had happened to her in her entire life. And somehow, Catra believed her. She actually felt the same way. They've only known each other for like ten minutes but it felt like an eternity. It felt just*… right*.

She looked at Adora, failing to form any words that could do the situation justice.

Thankfully, Scorpia was there.

"THAT IS THE CUTEST THING I'VE EVER HEARD!! I'M SO HAPPY FOR YOU!!"

This overly excited statement was supported by a high-pitched shriek and punctuated by another bear hug that included Catra *and* Adora.

After a few seconds of awkward fumbling and murmured "thank you"s, Scopria let them down to breath. Somehow the two of them ended up embracing one another, when they stood on their own feet again. Neither could say who had initiated this, but it wasn't important anyway. They looked deep into each other's eyes and while Scorpia discretely left the scene, they started to close the distance between them. The following kiss was the best first kiss Catra could imagine – and it certainly wouldn't be their last.

When they had to come up for air, Adora's smile was impossibly wide.

"So, would you like to upgrade our previous arrangement and be my real girlfriend?"

Catra smiled back. She knew she had to be looking incredibly dopy and the whole situation was disgustingly sappy, but she didn't care.

"I would be proud to."

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

> Hello, lovely people!
> This new chapter might be a surprise to you, but it is to me as well, haha.
> See, this fic was kind of dedicated to a girl. I didn't really know at the time that I had written it for her, thinking of how it maybe could be us in the future. Back then, I started writing stories for her and today, I'm still doing that. This girl has become my girlfriend and since a few months ago, my wife. So, this is a kind of late wedding present for her. And a promise that we'll make it to pride as well one day, when it's safe again.
> And now, have fun with this last chapter!

Catra was nervous. Today was the 5th anniversary of her first pride parade, which also means it was the 5th anniversary of her and Adora becoming girlfriends. So much has happened since then…

Catra had pried herself away from her toxic home, slowly but surely. She had not only fully come to terms with her sexuality, but also with herself. She now was a better, lighter version of herself. She would never be as loud in demanding her rights as Bow or Sparkles. She'd never be as peaceful as Perfuma or as optimistic as Scorpia. She was still her snarky, sarcastic self, but also… more complete.

The process hadn't been easy. It wasn't like the last piece of a puzzle had clicked into place those 5 years ago, no. But it had been Catra's first steps into a world where she could freely and openly be her true self, the person she'd always secretly longed to be, without the fear of rejection. Where she could trust that whatever she'd do, someone would always have her back. Someone would catch her if she'd fall. She had found new friends,

she had formed deeper bonds with old friends and she had fallen in love.

Adora was her world. Her light on cloudy days and her rock during stormy nights. There was no one else on this planet Catra would trust more. No one who allowed Catra to fully be herself, with every weird hobby, with every dark thought and with every childish delight. It was as if Adora had given Catra the key to unlock parts of herself that she had buried a long time ago or that she has always been too afraid to even explore in the first place. Catra wasn't a different person today than she has been 5 years ago. She was just more *Catra* than she's ever been before.

Today, she wanted to go the next step. So, she found herself walking down the crowded roads of Bride Moon, head up, nodding to friends or friends of friends who she could make out in the busy wave of people, a nervous smile on her face. She still wasn't going around waving rainbow flags or signs, but she did have some rainbow paint on her fingernails. She was wearing her old biker boots, even if they were almost falling apart in some places, and one of Adora's jackets over a red silk shirt. Her air was up in a high ponytail and her pocket was burning with the small velvet box she had been carrying around for a while now.

After a few minutes of searching at the meet up spot, she finally made out Scorpias enormous shape in the crowd. Catra instantly felt relieved at seeing her friend. Smiling widely and waving in a way that had to hurt her arm, Scorpia made her way over, closely followed by Entrapta, Perfuma, Mermista and Sea Hawk.

"There you are, Kitty!" Scorpia scooped Catra up in a big hug after waiting for her nod of approval. "I'm so excited! We're all more than ready, I made sure of that!"

"She did. It was awful."

Mermista looked at her nails like she was bored, but Catra could see right through that. At this point, she knew how to tell apart the emotions of the blue-haired woman, who has quickly become

her favorite in Adora's group of friends 5 years ago. Catra and Mermista would usually spend some quiet time together when everyone else would be just a bit too much for them.

"Everything will be perfect, don't you worry about that!" Sea Hawk chimed in, putting one arm around Mermista while pushing his other fist into the air. "Together, we can do anything! And I also have a surprise for you, it will blow you away, for sure!"

For the last part, he had leaned over to Catra as if he was telling her a secret. Even before she could worry about what exactly he had meant by that, Perfuma had already pushed Sea Hawk out of the way.

"Sea Hawk! We told you, no explosives!"

"But it's just a teeny tiny…"

"No!"

Catra couldn't help but smile at these idiots. She should probably be worried about Sea Hawk blowing all of them up or someone else messing up the plan or – most likely – herself forgetting everything they had carefully arranged these past few days. But she wasn't. She felt like she was where she should be, with the people who should be with her right now. At this point, there was only a spark of excitement in her chest that grew with every passing minute. Everything had led her to this. Everything had let her to…

"Adora!" Scorpia shouted, being the first one to see Glimmer, Bow and Adora pressing through the masses.

Catra's heartbeat picked up as she looked around, skimming over happy faces, crazy outfits and rainbow colors. Then her eyes landed on her beautiful girlfriend. Adora was wearing a long, white dress with golden accents. Her long hair fell openly on her shoulders and down her back. The most radiant smile showed up on her face as soon as Catra and Adora locked eyes.

“Hey, guys! Sorry, we’re late. Someone”, Sparkles said while coming closer and nudging Bow, “took forever in the bathroom to get his hair in the right shape.”

“This style needs a lot of care, okay?” Bow defended himself but smiled. He put his arms around Glimmer and pecked her cheek.

“Hi, babe”, Adora hugged Catra and gave her a sweet kiss after greeting the group. “Remind me again why I didn’t come here with my amazing girlfriend instead of those two?” She playfully gestured to Glimmer and Bow over her shoulder.

“Hey, we can hear you!”, Sparkles shouted while Bow just laughed.

“I thought it’s tradition we meet in the crowd.” Catra smirked and nudged Adora.

It was indeed somewhat of a weird tradition they came up with after they first met. They would go to each pride parade separately and meet in the crowd like the first time. It felt as exciting every year. And this year, Catra was especially thankful for it, since it gave her enough time to prepare everything.

“You’re right, it is.” Adora lovingly smiled at Catra while putting her arms around her again. “I just missed you this morning.”

Catra looked deep into her girlfriend’s eyes, still wondering, after 5 years, how she had gotten so lucky to be with this amazing woman.

“Aww, look at these two! As in love as on the first day!” Perfuma squealed.

Adora and Catra just laughed along with their everyone else, content in their bubble of friends in the middle of the raging crowd.

While everyone talked about what was going on in their lives, Catra gave Entrapta the signal (they had to learn a whole set of

signs, since Entrapta insisted it was necessary for the "mission") who signaled back and vanished in between the partying people. At the same time, Bow and Glimmer began to usher everyone into the space in front of the big stage.

Now it was getting real. Catra's nerves started to kick in again as she tried to seem as calm as possible.

"Hey, you okay?" Adora looked at Catra concerned, squeezing her hand. "You look more spooked than when we first met." She tried to make her laugh.

Catra smiled but could feel how wobbly it must look. *Damn it!* She really thought she'd be more put together at this point. She slowly breathed in and out as the DJ – Frosta, another friend of the group – started to play Adora's favorite song.

As soon as the melody started, their friends moved away from them. In fact, everyone else moved away from them, forming a ring around Catra and Adora.

Adora looked around confused, clearly not knowing what's going on, while Scorpia gave Catra a thumbs up and a goofy grin from the crowd that started to dance in synch to the song.

"What's going on here?" Adora asked in wonder.

"Do you remember when we watched this cheesy rom-com and you said you'd love to be in the middle of a flashmob one day? Well, here it is." Catra tried to explain without stumbling over her words.

Everything came just rushing in on her, the music, all the people dancing, Adora's questioning face. Catra knew what she was supposed to do, what she *wanted* to do. She had gone over this a million times, and she had been ready. It was almost time and she started to panic, since her feet were still glued to the ground.

Then Adora's hand squeezed Catra's again and suddenly, everything was quiet. There were only Adora and her, nothing else

around them mattered. Adora smiled at her encouragingly and finally, Catra could move again.

She lifted up Adora's hand, looked into her eyes and gestured to the space in front of them as if to ask for a dance, right as the music began to slow down.

Adora smiled and let herself be led into a gentle dance.

The crowd around them had gone quiet – well, as quiet as it could be in a place like this –, slowly moving in rhythm with them.

"Adora…" Catra started. She knew she could do it. She felt the same calm and peace as before. She was surrounded by warmth and in the arms of the most important person in her life. Nothing bad could happen to her. "The first time you and I met, I was in a different place than I am now. I was angry and afraid and closed up. I had built so many walls during my life, I would've never expected someone to just be able to go around them. But you did. You *saw* me. And you made your way over to me, just asking to be led in. That in itself already is a miracle to me. But me being able to say yes to you – to your crazy question about being your pride-girlfriend", Catra smiled at Adora who had the most loving expression on her face, "was even more miraculous to me. The start of our relationship has been anything but ordinary, so the next step should match that."

Catra swirled Adora around, catching her again and dipping her close to the ground. For a second, they just stared at each other, into each other's souls. And everything was right.

Catra brought Adora up again, closed her arms around her and finally asked the question she's been wanting to ask for a long time:

"Would you like to upgrade our previous arrangement and be my pride-wife? And also, my wife for any other time of the year?"

Adora's eyes glistened as she smiled the dopiest smile Catra has ever seen.

“I would be proud to.”

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!